

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

TOM DEFALCO would like to thank Mark Gruenwald who believed that people would enjoy reading books like this and was the driving force behind the original Official Handbooks of the Marvel Universe. HOO-HA, my friend!

TOM BREVOORT would like to thank Stan, Jack, Steve and all the rest, for doing the hard part and coming up with all of these characters and concepts in the first place.

MICHAEL TEITELBAUM would like to thank Danny Fingerhuth for the invaluable loan of the books and for his generosity in sharing his knowledge of the Marvel Universe, and Peter Sanderson for his help in identifying some of the characters; Alastair Dougall for bringing me on board and for his endless help and patience; Mike Hobson and John Romita, Sr. for the magazine (nod to Tom D. there as well!); Stan Lee, Steve Ditko, and Jack Kirby for starting all this; and my mom and dad, who—back when you could buy two comic books and a piece of gum for 25 cents—always gave me that quarter.

ANDREW DARLING would like to thank Keith Martin for those hyper-detailed responses to tricky questions, and the guys at Travelling Man in Manchester, who rescued me more than once. Big cheers go to Simon Beecroft for putting me forward for this gig, Alastair Dougall, who kept coming back for more, and Laura Gilbert, who couldn't quite get away. Finally, special thanks go to Ruth, who now knows a lot more about the Marvel Universe than she did, and Elijah—always a welcome distraction.

DANIEL WALLACE would like to dedicate my work on this book to the memory of my friend Dan Zoch, who introduced me to Marvel comics.

PETER SANDERSON would like to thank Jeff Christiansen, Tom Brevoort, Mike Fichera and Sean McQuaid for helping me resolve some continuity conundrums

DORLING KINDERSLEY would like to thank Thomas Murphy and Jeff Poulin at Marvel; Mark Perry at Avalon Comics and Will at 30th Century Comics; Lindsay Kent, Amy Junor, Elizabeth Noble, Laura Gilbert, Alan Cowsill, Laura Baxter, Lynne Moulding, and Cynthia O'Neill for editorial assistance; Guy Harvey for design assistance; Marian Anderson for the index.

